

Data Governance Note — Promotion & Article Master Data

As if presenting to a Data Integrity team lead, based on a 300-exception scan across 1,127 article and promotion records (Store24 Master Data Quality Engine, synthetic dataset).

1. Root Causes of Recurring Exceptions

300 exceptions fall into five root-cause groups, not twelve unrelated problems — fixing the process behind each group addresses several error types at once.

Root cause	Error types affected	N
No system-enforced validation at entry	Invalid barcode, margin breach, missing fields, tobacco on promotion	73
No dependency check before status changes	Discontinued before promo, cancelled header still live	69
Multibuy applied without checking unit of sale	Multibuy on non-unit article	33
No duplicate check at article creation	Duplicate article	31
No calendar validation on promotion dates	Item outside campaign dates, expired but marked live	42
Promo creation doesn't check ranging first	Not ranged in store group	23

The top two groups account for 142 of 300 exceptions (47%) and are process gaps, not one-off mistakes — the two worth fixing first.

2. Preventive Controls

Control	What it stops
Mandatory-field enforcement at entry	base_uom, tax_code, approval_status become required, not optional
Real-time margin floor check	Blocks a promo price below cost at the point of entry
Barcode check-digit validation on save	Rejects an invalid GTIN/EAN-13 before it reaches the till
Category-based compliance gate	Blocks promotion creation outright for tobacco articles
Dependency check before status change	Flags an article being discontinued while still on active promos
Listing validation gate	Promo can't go live in a store group unless the article is ranged there
Automated status close-out	Nightly job expires promos whose header_end has passed
Fuzzy-match duplicate warning	Flags a new article against near-identical existing descriptions

3. Monthly Data Quality Scorecard

Metric	What it shows	This scan
Exception rate	% of scanned records with an open exception	26.6%
Critical count open	Compliance breaches or blocked downstream systems	95
Time-to-resolution	Avg. days from exception raised to closed	not yet tracked
% passing first submission	Are controls reducing new exceptions, not just the backlog	not yet tracked

26.6% is high by design (seeded test errors run far above a live rate) — the trend line after the eight controls land is what matters, and whether the last two metrics start being tracked at all.

4. Where This Ties to UAT

The twelve checks are, functionally, a ready-made regression suite. Re-run the relevant ones before sign-off on any master-data-touching change:

System change	Re-run these checks
Promotion creation workflow	Referential integrity, listing conflict, header/item date
Pricing engine	Margin breach, tobacco on promotion
Article master bulk update / migration	Barcode validity, completeness, duplicate
Article/promotion status handling	Dependency-timing, orphaned-header (the two largest groups above)

Automated regression beats manual spot-checks: it's the difference between catching a defect before go-live and finding it in production three weeks later.